MUSICANEO

Lori Laitman

Echo — bass and piano (priced for 2 copies)

Piano-vocal score

Lyrics by Christina Georgina Rossetti

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LORI LAITMAN COMPOSER

ECHO

for bass and piano



Music by **LORI LAITMAN**
Poem by **CHRISTINA ROSSETTI**

Enchanted Knickers Music, BMI — lori@artsongs.com

MUSICANEO

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Echo

Written in 1854 by Christina Rossetti (1830-1894)

Come to me in the silence of the night;
  Come in the speaking silence of a dream;
Come with soft rounded cheeks and eyes as bright
  As sunlight on a stream;
    Come back in tears,
O memory, hope, love of finished years.

Oh dream how sweet, too sweet, too bitter sweet,
  Whose wakening should have been in Paradise,
Where souls brimfull of love abide and meet;
  Where thirsting longing eyes
    Watch the slow door
That opening, letting in, lets out no more.

Yet come to me in dreams, that I may live
  My very life again tho' cold in death:
Come back to me in dreams, that I may give
  Pulse for pulse, breath for breath:
    Speak low, lean low,
As long ago, my love, how long ago.

Program Notes

I composed this song in 1995 for my friend and Yale classmate, baritone Robert Kennedy. *Echo* uses a simple ABA structure. To draw the listener into the singer's reverie, I employ a repetitive pattern of octaves in the right hand of the piano over a pedal point in the left hand.

Echo premiered at Weill Recital Hall, March 13, 1996 with soprano Karen Bogan, soprano and pianist Brian Zeger.

PERFORMANCE NOTES

Pedal should be applied liberally throughout. When unmarked, pedaling choices are left to the pianist; when marked, pedaling is directed toward a specific intent, e.g., sustain sound throughout a rest once hands have lifted. Other markings are guidelines — I am most interested in an expressive performance.

PRINTING INSTRUCTIONS

This score is to be printed double-sided on 8.5 x 11 paper, starting with the Laitman cover. This Musicaneo license allows you to print 2 copies of the score, one for each musician. Please do not share the files.

If you are performing this work in concert, please send a copy of the program, with my name circled, to BMI so I can receive performance royalties. Here is the address:

BMI, 7 World Trade Center, 250 Greenwich Street, New York, NY 10007-0030. Please write "Attention: Classical Music" on the envelope.

Alternately, you can email me at lori@artsongs.com with a PDF of the program.

Please include proper poetry credits in any program.

Thank you.

LORI LAITMAN BIO

Described by Fanfare Magazine as "one of the most talented and intriguing of living composers," **Lori Laitman** has composed multiple operas and choral works, and hundreds of songs, setting texts by classical and contemporary poets (including those who perished in the Holocaust). Her music is widely performed, internationally and throughout the United States, and has generated substantial critical acclaim. *The Journal of Singing* wrote "It is difficult to think of anyone before the public today who equals her exceptional gifts for embracing a poetic text and giving it new and deeper life through music." For more information, please visit www.artsongs.com.

Bass

ECHO

for Robert Kennedy

CHRISTINA ROSSETTI

LORI LAITMAN

Tempo should be flexible throughout, with a slight push for a crescendo and slight relaxation for a descrescendo.

♩ = 80

mf *extremely legato*

mp

Ped. ✻ Ped. ✻ *simile*

poco rit. **a tempo**

5

mp

Come to me in the

poco rit. **a tempo**

5

mf *mp* *p*

Ped. ✻ Ped. ✻ Ped. ✻ Ped. ✻ *simile*

poco rit.

10

mf pleading

si-lence of the night; Come to me, Come to me,

poco rit.

10

mf

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Slightly faster (♩ = 88)
poco rit.
Tempo Iº (♩ = 80)
14
mf
Come in the speak-ing si-lence of a dream;
Come with soft round-ed
mp
19
f
rubato
a tempo
cheeks and eyes as bright as sun-light on a stream;
Come back in
mf
p
poco a poco accel.
24
tears, O mem-o-ry,
hope,
love
of fin-ished
sub.



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42
f
3
Where souls brim - ful of love a - bide and meet;
42
f
3
3
46
mf
poco rit.
mp
Where thirst - ing long - ing eyes watch the slow
46
poco rit.
mf
mp
50
p
poco accel.
f
door that o-pen-ing, let-ting in, lets out
poco accel.
50
p
f


poco rit.
rubato
linger
54
mp
mp
no
more
Yet
poco rit.
rubato
linger
54
mp
mf
Ped.
Tempo Iº
poco rit.
59
f
mp
port.
come to me in dreams that I may live my ve - ry life a - gain though cold in
Tempo Iº
poco rit.
59
p
f
mp
a tempo
64
mf
f
death;
Come back to me in dreams that I may give
a tempo
64
mf
f


linger a tempo linger
69
p mp p mp
Pulse for pulse breath for breath: Speak low, lean
linger a tempo linger
69
sub. p mp p mp
a tempo poco accel. poco rit. rubato
74
mp p f mp
low, As long a - go, my love, my love how long a -
a tempo poco accel. poco rit. rubato
74
mp p f mp
a tempo poco rit.
79
go.
a tempo poco rit.
79
mf mp p pp
Ped. Ped. 8va

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